

Short stories on Bregman divergences: Flat and curved geometries

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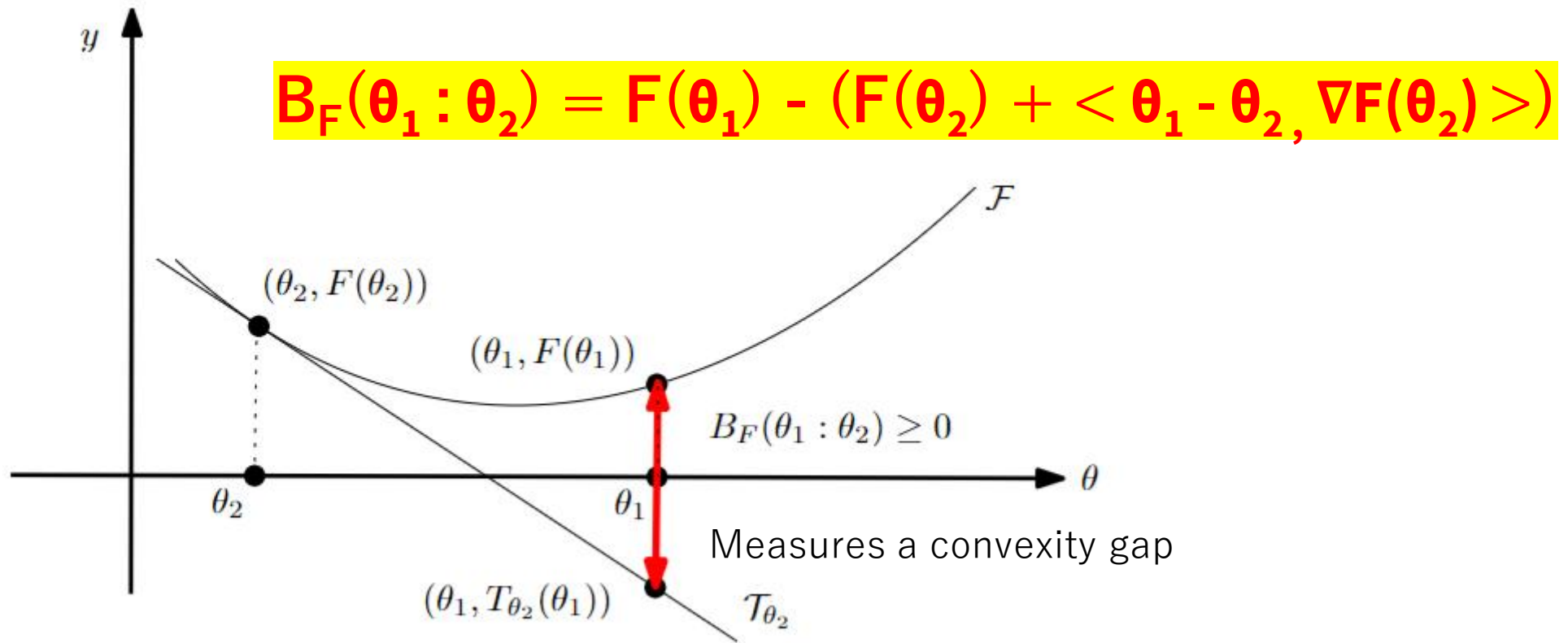


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Bregman divergences

- Let $F: \Theta \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a strictly convex and smooth real-valued function on a finite-dimensional Hilbert space $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$

Bregman divergence $B_F: \Theta \times \text{Int}(\Theta) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$



Originally introduced for (left-sided) Bregman projections with applications to LP approximations

A versatile class of dissimilarities

Bregman divergences **unify** various distortions in applications

- ***squared Euclidean divergence*** from $F(\theta) = \frac{1}{2} \theta^T Q \theta$, **Quadratic negentropy**:

$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = \frac{1}{2} (\theta_2 - \theta_1)^T Q (\theta_2 - \theta_1) = \frac{1}{2} \|\theta_2 - \theta_1\|_Q^2$$

- ***Kullback-Leibler divergence*** from $F(\theta) = -\sum_i \theta_i \log(\theta_i)$, **Shannon negentropy**:

$$B_F(\theta : \theta') = \sum_i \{ \theta_i \log(\theta_i / \theta'_i) + \theta'_i - \theta_i \} = \sum_i \theta_i \log(\theta_i / \theta'_i)$$



- ***Itakura-Saito divergence*** from $F(\theta) = \sum_i -\log(\theta_i)$, **Burg negentropy**:

$$B_F(\theta : \theta') = \sum_i \{ (\theta_i / \theta'_i) - \log(\theta_i / \theta'_i) - 1 \}$$



$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = F(\theta_1) - (F(\theta_2) + \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, \nabla F(\theta_2) \rangle)$$

BD interpreted as **remainder** of a first order Taylor expression of $F(\theta_1)$ around θ_2 :

$$F(\theta_1) = F(\theta_2) + \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, \nabla F(\theta_2) \rangle + \underbrace{B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2)}_{\text{Taylor remainder}}$$

Example of remainder:

Lagrange remainder (smooth C^2 generators):

$$\nabla^2 F \text{ SPD} \Rightarrow B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) \geq 0$$

$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = \frac{1}{2} (\theta_2 - \theta_1)^\top \nabla^2 F(\theta) (\theta_2 - \theta_1) \geq 0, \theta \in [\theta_1, \theta_2]$$

Bregman divergences in machine learning...

- Kullback-Leibler divergence between two probability densities:

$$D_{KL}[p(x):q(x)] = \int p(x) \log(p(x)/q(x)) d\mu(x)$$

is **difficult to calculate in closed form** because of the integral $\int \dots$

- But Kullback-Leibler divergence between two probability densities of a **natural exponential family** with densities $p(x|\theta) \propto \exp(\langle x, \theta \rangle)$ amount to a **reverse Bregman divergence** $B_F^{\text{rev}}(\theta_1 : \theta_2) := B_F(\theta_2 : \theta_1)$

$$D_{KL}[p(x|\theta_1) : p(x|\theta_2)] = B_F^{\text{rev}}(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = B_F(\theta_2 : \theta_1)$$

Bypass the $\int, \nabla F$ in BD easy to calculate!

$\Rightarrow$ Easy calculations of KLDs

Convex duality via Legendre-Fenchel transform

- Legendre-Fenchel transform of a convex function F :

$$F^*(\eta) = \sup_{\theta \in \Theta} \{ \langle \theta, \eta \rangle - F(\theta) \}$$

- Problem: some *tricky functions* with gradient map ∇F domain **not convex**...

Example: $h(\xi_1, \xi_2) = [(\xi_1^2/\xi_2) + \xi_1^2 + \xi_2^2]/4$ on upper plane domain $\Xi = (\xi_1, \xi_2)$

- Thus, we consider “**nice convex functions**” = **Legendre-type functions** $(\Theta, F(\theta))$
(i) Θ open, and (ii) $\lim_{\theta \rightarrow \partial \Theta} \|\nabla F(\theta)\| = \infty$

Then we get:

- ① reciprocal gradient maps** $\eta = \nabla F(\theta)$ and $\theta = \nabla F^*(\eta)$, $\nabla F^* = (\nabla F)^{-1}$
- ② conjugation yields** $(H, F^*(\eta))$ of Legendre type
- ③ biconjugation is an involution:** $(H, F^*(\eta))^* = (H^* = \Theta, F^{**} = F(\theta))$

- Convex conjugate: $F^*(\eta) = \langle \nabla F^{-1}(\eta), \eta \rangle - F(\nabla F^{-1}(\eta))$ since $\eta = \nabla F(\theta)$

Fenchel-Young divergences

- Young inequality: $F(\theta_1) + F^*(\eta_2) \geq \langle \theta_1, \eta_2 \rangle$ with equality when $\eta_2 = \nabla F(\theta_1)$
- Build the Fenchel-Young divergence from the inequality: lhs-rhs ≥ 0

$$Y_{F, F^*}(\theta_1, \eta_2) = F(\theta_1) + F^*(\eta_2) - \langle \theta_1, \eta_2 \rangle \geq 0$$

- Mixed and dual parameterizations

$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = Y_{F, F^*}(\theta_1 : \eta_2) = Y_{F^*, F}(\eta_2, \theta_1) = B_{F^*}(\eta_2 : \eta_1)$$

$$\eta = \nabla F(\theta) \text{ and } \theta = \nabla F^*(\eta),$$

Reconstructing statistical divergences from Bregman divergences with integral generators

BDs $\Rightarrow$ Statistical divergences

Negentropy of mixture families $\Rightarrow$ KLD

$$\mathcal{M} := \left\{ m(x; \eta) = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i p_i(x) + (1 - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i) p_0(x) : \eta_i > 0, \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i < 1 \right\}$$

Bregman generator $G(\eta) = -h(m(x; \eta)) = \int_{x \in \mathcal{X}} m(x; \eta) \log m(x; \eta) d\mu(x)$

$$\eta_i = [\nabla F(\theta)]_i = \int (p_i(x) - p_0(x)) \log m_\theta(x) d\mu(x) \quad F^*(\eta) = - \int p_0(x) \log m_\theta(x) d\mu(x) = h^\times(p_0 : m_\theta)$$

$$\theta_1^\top \eta_2 = \int \sum_i \theta_1(i) p_i \log m_{\theta_2} d\mu - \sum_i \theta_1(i) p_0 \log m_{\theta_2} d\mu.$$

$$\begin{aligned} B_{F, \mathcal{M}}[m_{\theta_1} : m_{\theta_2}] &:= F(\theta_1) + F^*(\eta_2) - \theta_1^\top \eta_2, \\ &= -h(m_{\theta_1}) - \int p_0(x) \log m_{\theta_2}(x) d\mu(x) - \int \sum_i \theta_1(i) p_i(x) \log m_{\theta_2}(x) d\mu(x) \\ &\quad + \sum_i \theta_1(i) p_0(x) \log m_{\theta_2}(x) d\mu(x), \\ &= -h(m_{\theta_1}) - \int ((1 - \sum_i \theta_1(i)) p_0(x) + \sum_i \theta_1(i) p_i(x)) \log m_{\theta_2}(x) d\mu(x), \\ &= -h(m_{\theta_1}) - \int m_{\theta_1}(x) \log m_{\theta_2}(x) d\mu(x), \\ &= \int m_{\theta_1}(x) \log \frac{m_{\theta_1}(x)}{m_{\theta_2}(x)} d\mu(x), \\ &= D_{\text{KL}}[m_{\theta_1} : m_{\theta_2}]. \end{aligned}$$

Cumulant of exponential families $\Rightarrow$ KLD*

$$F(\theta) = F_{\mathcal{E}}(p_{\theta}) = \log \left(\int \exp(\theta^{\top} t(x)) d\mu(x) \right) \quad F^*(\eta) = -h(p_{\theta}) = \int p(x) \log p(x) d\mu(x)$$

$$\eta_2(i) = E_{p_{\theta_2}}[t_i(x)]$$

$$\sum_i \theta_1(i) \eta_2(i) = E_{p_{\theta_2}} [\sum_i \theta_1(i) t_i(x)]$$

$$\sum_i \theta_1(i) t_i(x) = (\log p_{\theta_1}(x)) + F(\theta_1)$$

$$\text{hence } \theta_1^{\top} \eta_2 = E_{p_{\theta_2}} [\log p_{\theta_1} + F(\theta_1)] = F(\theta_1) + E_{p_{\theta_2}} [\log p_{\theta_1}]$$

$$\begin{aligned} B_{F, \mathcal{E}}[p_{\theta_1} : p_{\theta_2}] &= F(\theta_1) + F^*(\eta_2) - \theta_1^{\top} \eta_2, \\ &= \cancel{F(\theta_1)} - h(p_{\theta_2}) - E_{p_{\theta_2}} [\log p_{\theta_1}] - \cancel{F(\theta_1)}, \\ &= E_{p_{\theta_2}} \left[\log \frac{p_{\theta_2}}{p_{\theta_1}} \right] =: D_{\text{KL}^*}[p_{\theta_1} : p_{\theta_2}], \end{aligned}$$

BD induced by cumulant function = **reverse KLD** on corresponding densities

Partition function of exponential families $\Rightarrow$ eKLD*

- The **partition function** $Z = \exp(F)$ is **log-convex** and hence also convex. We get two BDs B_Z and B_F from exp. families.

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\text{KL}}(\tilde{p}_{\theta_1} : \tilde{p}_{\theta_2}) &= \int \left(\tilde{p}_{\theta_1}(x) \log \frac{\tilde{p}_{\theta_1}(x)}{\tilde{p}_{\theta_2}(x)} + \tilde{p}_{\theta_2}(x) - \tilde{p}_{\theta_1}(x) \right) d\mu(x), \\ &= \int \left(e^{\langle t(x), \theta_1 \rangle} \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, t(x) \rangle + e^{\langle t(x), \theta_2 \rangle} - e^{\langle t(x), \theta_1 \rangle} \right) d\mu(x), \\ &= \left\langle \int t(x) e^{\langle t(x), \theta_1 \rangle} d\mu(x), \theta_1 - \theta_2 \right\rangle + Z(\theta_2) - Z(\theta_1), \\ &= \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, \nabla Z(\theta_1) \rangle + Z(\theta_2) - Z(\theta_1) = B_Z(\theta_2 : \theta_1), \end{aligned}$$

$$p_\lambda(x) \propto \tilde{p}_\lambda(x) = \exp(\langle \theta(\lambda), t(x) \rangle) h(x).$$

$$p_\lambda(x) = \frac{1}{Z(\lambda)} \tilde{p}_\lambda(x)$$

$$Z(\lambda) = \int \tilde{p}_\lambda(x) d\mu(x)$$

Sub-dimensional families of Bregman divergences

Proposition *A multivariate Bregman divergence $B_F(\theta : \theta')$ can be written equivalently as a scalar Bregman divergence $B_{F_{\theta,\theta'}}(0 : 1)$ so that*

$$\forall \theta \in \Theta, \theta' \in \text{int}(\theta), \quad B_F(\theta : \theta') = B_{F_{\theta,\theta'}}(0 : 1),$$

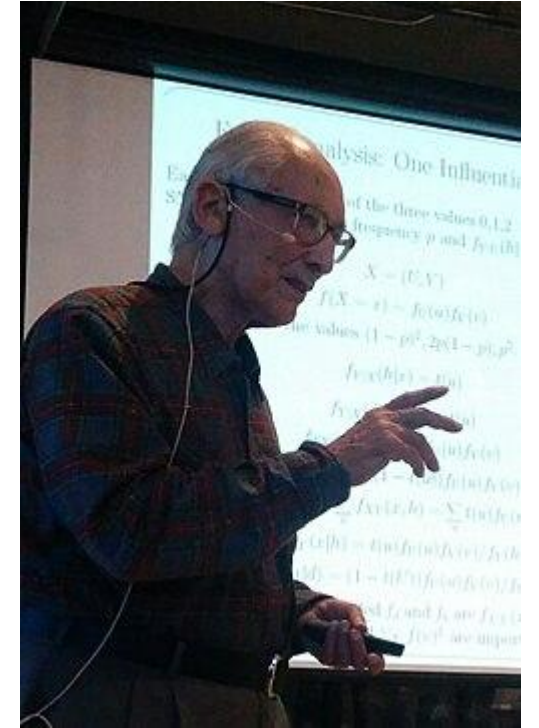
where $F_{\theta,\theta'}(u) := F(\theta + u(\theta' - \theta))$ is a univariate Bregman generator.

$$\begin{aligned} B_{F_{\theta,\theta'}}(0 : 1) &:= F_{\theta,\theta'}(0) - F_{\theta,\theta'}(1) - (0 - 1)\nabla_{\theta' - \theta} F_{\theta,\theta'}(1), \\ &= F(\theta) - F(\theta') + \langle \theta' - \theta, \nabla F(\theta') \rangle = B_F(\theta : \theta'). \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_{\theta' - \theta} F_{\theta,\theta'}(u) &:= \lim_{\epsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{F(\theta + (\epsilon + u)(\theta' - \theta)) - F(\theta + u(\theta' - \theta))}{\epsilon}, \\ &= \langle \theta' - \theta, \nabla F(\theta + u(\theta' - \theta)) \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Information geometry of Chernoff information

Chernoff distribution, Chernoff point, LREF



July 1, 1923 (age 103)

$$C(P, Q) = -\log \min_{\alpha \in (0,1)} \int p^\alpha(x) q^{1-\alpha}(x) d\nu(x)$$

CI useful in statistics, information fusion, etc.

$$C(P_1, P_2) \triangleq - \min_{0 \leq \lambda \leq 1} \log \left(\sum_x P_1^\lambda(x) P_2^{1-\lambda}(x) \right)$$

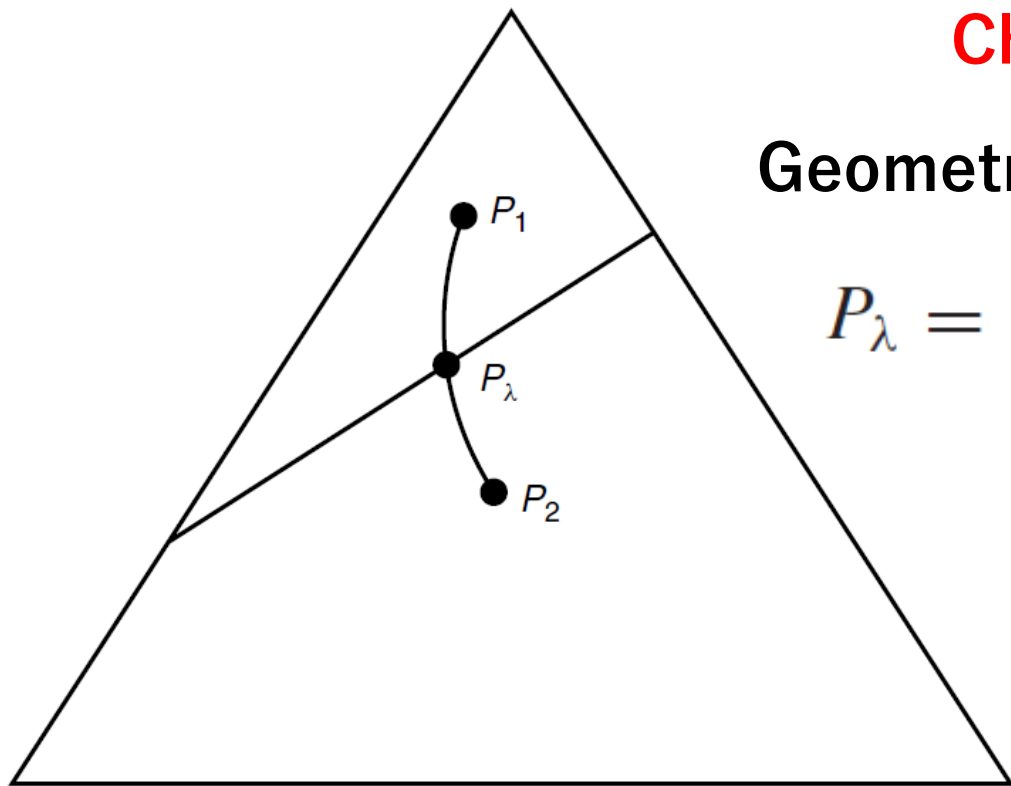
$$= D(P_{\lambda^*} || P_1) = D(P_{\lambda^*} || P_2)$$

Voronoi bisector

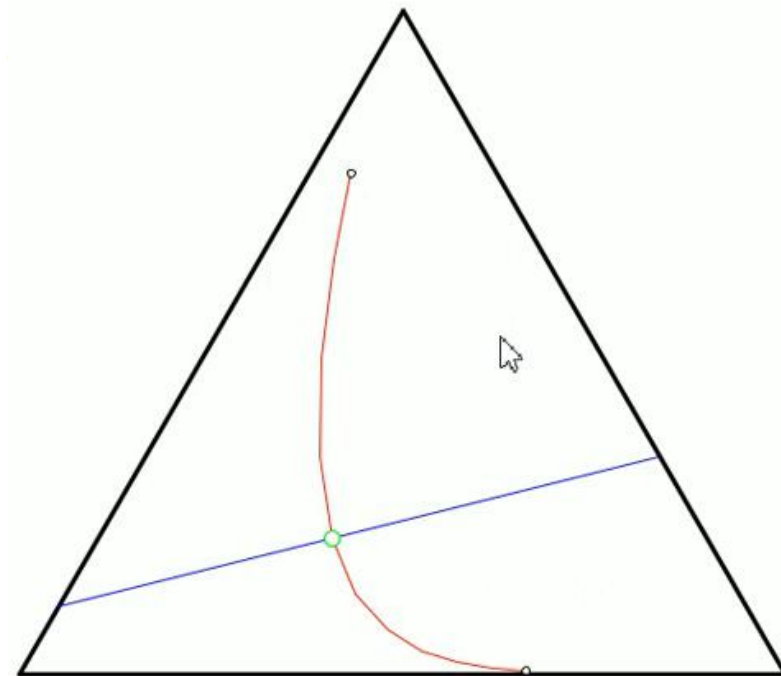
Chernoff distribution

Geometric mixture

$$P_\lambda = \frac{P_1^\lambda(x) P_2^{1-\lambda}(x)}{\sum_{a \in \mathcal{X}} P_1^\lambda(a) P_2^{1-\lambda}(a)}$$



(Fig. from Thomas & Cover textbook)



Likelihood ratio exponential families (LREFs)

exponential open arc $\{g_\alpha(x) : \alpha \in (0, 1)\}$

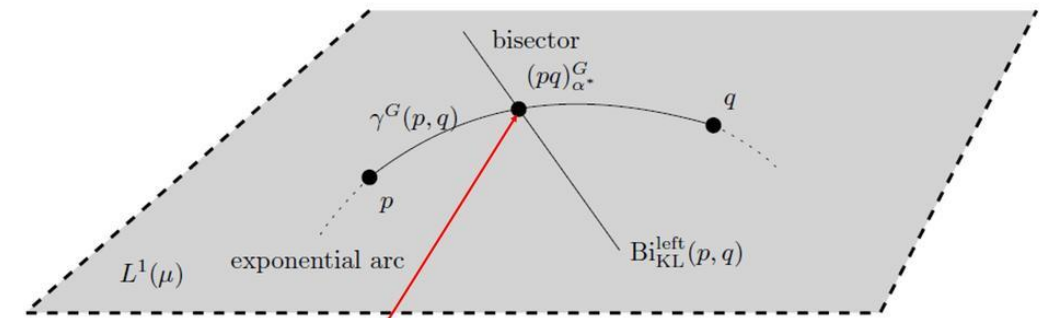
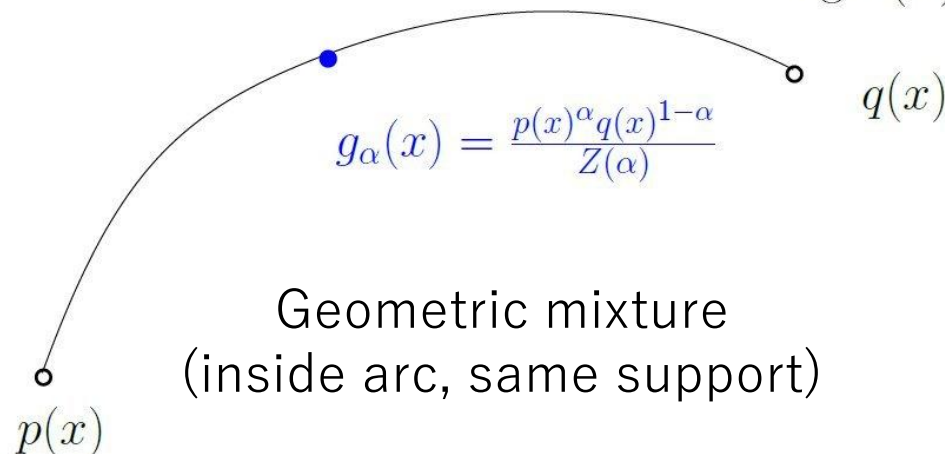
is an exponential family $g_\alpha(x) = \exp\left(\alpha \log \frac{p(x)}{q(x)} - \log Z(\alpha)\right) q(x)$

Convex

$$Z(\alpha) = \int p(x)^\alpha q(x)^{1-\alpha} d\mu(x)$$

$$\log Z(\alpha) = -D_\alpha^{\text{Bhattacharyya}}[p : q]$$

**Cumulant of LREF
is negative Bhatt. dist.**



Chernoff point $(pq)_{\alpha^*}^G = \gamma^G(p, q) \cap \text{Bi}_{\text{KL}}^{\text{left}}(p, q)$

Bhattacharya distance is not a metric distance

$$D_{\text{Bhat}, \alpha}[p : q] := -\log \int_{\mathcal{X}} p(x)^\alpha q(x)^{1-\alpha} d\mu(x) \quad \text{Concave in } \alpha$$

$$\gamma^G(p, q) := \{(pq)_\alpha^G : \alpha \in [0, 1]\}$$

$$\text{Bi}_{\text{KL}}^{\text{left}}(p, q) := \{r \in L^1(\mu) : D_{\text{KL}}[r : p] = D_{\text{KL}}[r : q]\}$$

"Revisiting Chernoff information with likelihood ratio exponential families." Entropy (2022)

Estimating KLDs/f-divergences
extended to positive densities

Monte Carlo estimation of ext. KL/f-divergences

$$D_{\text{KL}}(p : q) = \int p(x) \log \frac{p(x)}{q(x)} d\mu(x) \xrightarrow[\text{sampled from } p]{x_1, \dots, x_n} \widehat{\text{KL}}_n(p : q) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \log \frac{p(x_i)}{q(x_i)}$$

Problem: Estimated KLD may be negative. Bug/error in practice!

Definition 1 (Extended f -divergence) *The extended f -divergence for a convex generator f , strictly convex at 1 and satisfying $f(1) = 0$ is defined by*

$$\begin{aligned} I_f^e(p : q) &= \int p(x) \left(f\left(\frac{q(x)}{p(x)}\right) - f'(1) \left(\frac{q(x)}{p(x)} - 1\right) \right) d\mu(x). \\ &= \int p(x) \underbrace{B_f\left(\frac{q(x)}{p(x)} : 1\right)}_{\geq 0} d\mu(x) \geq 0. \end{aligned}$$

f -divergences are
equivalent modulo
affine terms

$$\widehat{\text{KL}}_n(p : q) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \left(\log \frac{p(x_i)}{q(x_i)} + \frac{q(x_i)}{p(x_i)} - 1 \right) \geq 0$$

Sigma points for the KLD between EF densities

- ▶ Bregman divergences $B_F = B_G$ iff $F \equiv G$ modulo an **affine term**
- ▶ Thus consider the equivalent generator $F_\omega(\theta) := -\log(p_\theta(\omega))$ for any $\omega \in \mathcal{X}$:

$$p_\theta(x) = \exp(\theta^\top t(x) - F(\theta))$$

$$F_\omega(\theta) := -\log(p_\theta(\omega)) = F(\theta) - \underbrace{(\theta^\top t(\omega) + k(\omega))}_{\text{affine term in } \theta}$$

- ▶ Since we have $\nabla F_\omega(\theta(\lambda_1)) = -(t(\omega) - \nabla F(\theta(\lambda_1)))$:

$$\begin{aligned} D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] &= B_{F_\omega}(\theta(\lambda_2) : \theta(\lambda_1)), \\ &= \log\left(\frac{p_{\lambda_1}(\omega)}{p_{\lambda_2}(\omega)}\right) - (\theta(\lambda_2) - \theta(\lambda_1))^\top \nabla_\theta F_\omega(\theta(\lambda_1)) \end{aligned}$$

$$D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] = \log\left(\frac{p_{\lambda_1}(\omega)}{p_{\lambda_2}(\omega)}\right) + (\theta(\lambda_2) - \theta(\lambda_1))^\top (t(\omega) - \nabla F(\theta(\lambda_1))), \quad \forall \omega \in \mathcal{X}$$

KLD for multi-order exponential families

- ▶ Choose $s \leq D + 1$ values for ω (i.e., $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_s$), and **average**:

$$D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] = \frac{1}{s} \sum_{i=1}^s \log \left(\frac{p_{\lambda_1}(\omega_i)}{p_{\lambda_2}(\omega_i)} \right) + (\theta(\lambda_2) - \theta(\lambda_1))^\top \left(\frac{1}{s} \sum_{i=1}^s t(\omega_i) - \nabla F(\theta(\lambda_1)) \right)$$

Theorem (KLD as sum of log density-ratios)

The Kullback-Leibler divergence between two densities p_{λ_1} and p_{λ_2} belonging to a full regular exponential family $\mathcal{E}$ of order D can be expressed as the average sum of logarithms of density ratios:

$$D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] = \frac{1}{s} \sum_{i=1}^s \log \left(\frac{p_{\lambda_1}(\omega_i)}{p_{\lambda_2}(\omega_i)} \right) \text{ such that } \frac{1}{s} \sum_{i=1}^s t(\omega_i) = E_{p_{\lambda_1}}[t(x)]$$

where $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_s$ are $s \leq D + 1$ distinct points of $\mathcal{X}$ chosen such that $\frac{1}{s} \sum_{i=1}^s t(\omega_i) = E_{p_{\lambda_1}}[t(x)]$.

Example: KLD between two multivariate normals (MVNs)

- ▶ Exponential family of d -dimensional normal densities: **order** $D = \frac{d(d+3)}{2}$.
- ▶ Use $s = 2d \leq D + 1$ **vectors** ω_i to express $p_{\mu_1, \Sigma_1} : p_{\mu_2, \Sigma_2}$:

$$\omega_i = \mu_1 - \sqrt{d\lambda_i}e_i, \omega_{i+d} = \mu_1 + \sqrt{d\lambda_i}e_i, i = \{1, \dots, d\}$$

where the λ_i 's are the **eigenvalues** of Σ_1 with the e_i 's corresponding **eigenvectors**.

- ▶ We have $\frac{1}{2d} \sum_{i=1}^{2d} \omega_i = E_{p_{\lambda_1}}[x] = \mu_1$ and $\frac{1}{2d} \sum_{i=1}^{2d} \omega_i \omega_i^\top = \mu_1 \mu_1^\top + \Sigma_1$.
- ▶ Let $\sqrt{\lambda_i}e_i = [\sqrt{\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i}$, the i -th column of the **square root** of the **covariance matrix** of Σ_1 . We have:

$$D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\mu_1, \Sigma_1} : p_{\mu_2, \Sigma_2}] =$$

$$\frac{1}{2d} \sum_{i=1}^d \left(\log \left(\frac{p_{\mu_1, \Sigma_1}(\mu_1 - [\sqrt{d\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i})}{p_{\mu_2, \Sigma_2}(\mu_1 - [\sqrt{d\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i})} \right) + \log \left(\frac{p_{\mu_1, \Sigma_1}(\mu_1 + [\sqrt{d\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i})}{p_{\mu_2, \Sigma_2}(\mu_1 + [\sqrt{d\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i})} \right) \right)$$

where $[\sqrt{d\Sigma_1}]_{\cdot, i} = \sqrt{\lambda_i}e_i$ denotes the vector extracted from the i -th column of the square root matrix of $d\Sigma_1$.

For illustration purpose only!!!

Characterizing Monte Carlo estimation error

- Monte Carlo KLD estimation: $\tilde{D}_{\text{KL}}^{\mathcal{S}_m}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \log \frac{p_{\lambda_1}(x_i)}{p_{\lambda_2}(x_i)}$
- The MC error can be **exactly quantified** for EF densities as

$$\left| \tilde{D}_{\text{KL}}^{\mathcal{S}_m}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] - D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\lambda_1} : p_{\lambda_2}] \right| = \left| (\theta(\lambda_2) - \theta(\lambda_1))^{\top} \left(\frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m t(x_i) - E_{p_{\lambda_1}}[t(x)] \right) \right|$$

When $m \rightarrow \infty$, we have $\frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m t(x_i) \rightarrow E_{p_{\lambda_1}}[t(x)]$

Consistent estimator

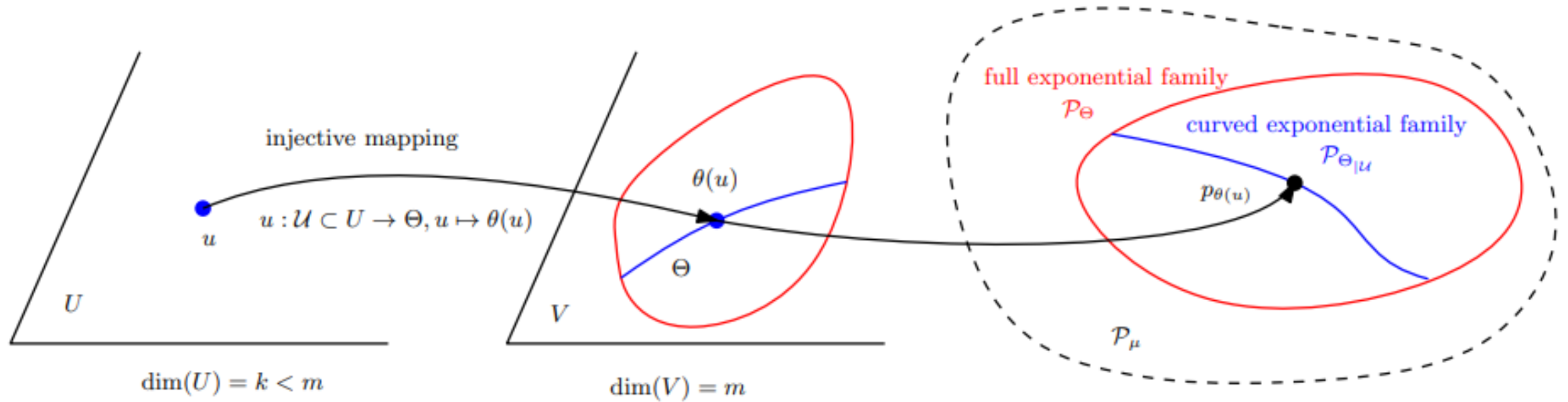
"Computing statistical divergences with sigma points." GSI 2021, Springer LNCS.

Curved Bregman divergences

Curved Bregman divergences (cBDs)

Consider a domain U which maps to a subset of Θ by $\theta = c(u)$ with $\dim(U) < \dim(\Theta)$: $\mathbf{B}_{F,c}(u_1 : u_2) := \mathbf{B}_F(c(u_1) : c(u_2))$ is not Bregman when $\{c(u) \mid u \in U\}$ not convex. cBDs usually not BDs unless constraints $c(\cdot)$ are affine

By analogy to **curved exponential families**



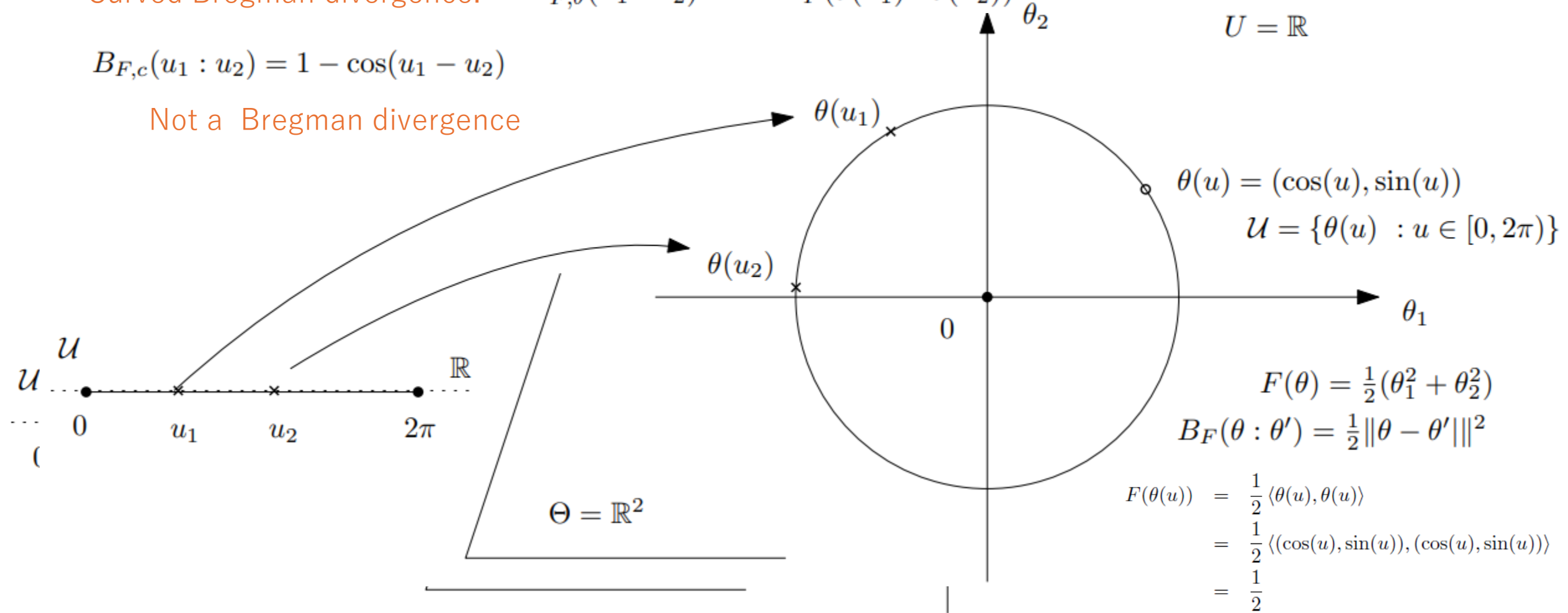
For example, U is real vector space,
 V is symmetric matrix vector space $\Sigma(u)$
CEF is sub-family of Gaussians $\{N(0, \Sigma(u)) : u \text{ in } U\}$

Curved Bregman divergence example: The **cosine dissimilarity** between unit vectors

Curved Bregman divergence: $B_{F,\theta}(u_1 : u_2) = B_F(\theta(u_1) : \theta(u_2))$

$$B_{F,c}(u_1 : u_2) = 1 - \cos(u_1 - u_2)$$

Not a Bregman divergence



arXiv:2504.05654

A constant on the circle submanifold, thus **not a proper Bregman generator!**

Example of curved BDs: Symmetrized BDs

= **Jeffreys-Bregman divergences** are curved Bregman divergences:

$$S_F(\theta_1, \theta_2) = \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, \eta_1 - \eta_2 \rangle$$

$$\begin{aligned} S_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) &= B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) + B_F(\theta_2 : \theta_1), \\ &= B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) + B_{F^*}(\nabla F(\theta_1) : \nabla F(\theta_2)) \\ &= \check{B}_{F_{\check{\zeta}}}(\check{\zeta}(\theta_1) : \check{\zeta}(\theta_2)), \end{aligned}$$

Curved domain:

$$\mathcal{U} = \{(\theta, \nabla F(\theta)) : \theta \in \Theta\}$$

$$\check{\zeta}(\theta) = (\theta, \nabla F(\theta)) \quad F_{\check{\zeta}}(\theta, \eta) := F(\theta) + F^*(\eta) \quad F^*(\eta) = \langle \theta, \eta \rangle - F(\theta)$$

m-dimensional submanifold in 2m-dimensional space

(usually not cvx affine space, hence *not a Bregman divergence*)

Only affine for quadratic generators (i.e., squared Mahalanobis divergences)

“Sided and symmetrized Bregman centroids.” *IEEE transactions on Information Theory* 55.6 (2009)

Another example of curved Bregman divergences:

- Consider d-variate **circular complex normal distributions** $\mathcal{CN}_d(\mu_{\mathbb{C}}, S_{\mathbb{C}})$
- CNDs handled as **2d real normal distributions** $N_{2d}([\mu_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}}, \frac{1}{2}[S_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}})$

$$[z = a + ib]_{\mathbb{R}} = (a, b) \quad [M = A + iB]_{\mathbb{R}} = \begin{bmatrix} A & -B \\ B & A \end{bmatrix}$$

- Then KLD between CNDs amounts to a **curved Bregman divergence**:

$$D_{\text{KL}}[p_{m_{\mathbb{C}}, S_{\mathbb{C}}} : p_{m'_{\mathbb{C}}, S'_{\mathbb{C}}}] = D_{\text{KL}}[p_{\mu, \Sigma} : p_{\mu', \Sigma'}] = B_F(\theta' : \theta)$$

Natural parameters
 $(\Sigma^{-1}\mu, \frac{1}{2}\Sigma^{-1})$

$\mu = [m_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}} \quad \Sigma = [S_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}} \text{ and } \mu' = [m'_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}} \quad \Sigma' = [S'_{\mathbb{C}}]_{\mathbb{R}}$

- **Curved submanifold** parameter in $\mathbb{R}^{2d} \times \text{Mat}(2d)$

$$\mathcal{U} = \left\{ (v, M) : v \in \mathbb{R}^{2d}, M = \begin{bmatrix} A & -B \\ B & A \end{bmatrix}, A \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d} \succ 0, B \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d} \succ 0 \right\}$$

2504.05654

See also Nakashika, T: "Complex-Valued Variational Autoencoder: A Novel Deep Generative Model for Direct Representation of Complex Spectra." *INTERSPEECH*. 2020.

Theorem: Curved Bregman centroid is the Bregman projection of the full Bregman centroid

Right Bregman projection of Bregman centroid $\bar{\theta} = \sum_i w_i \theta_i$

$$\arg \min_{u \in \mathcal{U}} \sum_{i=1}^n w_i B_F(\theta_i : \theta(u)) = \arg \min_{u \in \mathcal{U}} B_F(\bar{\theta} : \theta(u))$$

N-point opt.

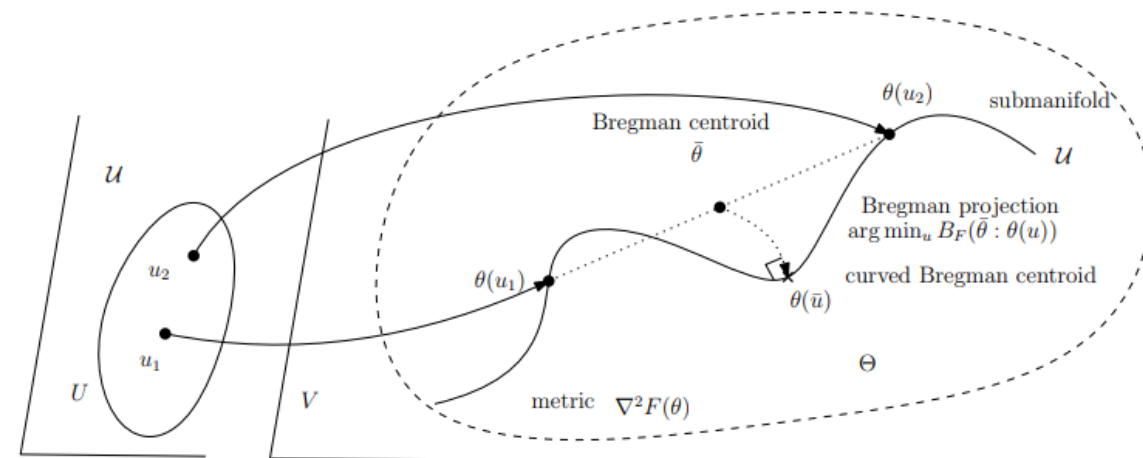
$$\theta_i = \theta(u_i)$$

From n-point opt
to

One-point opt!

Simple Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{u \in \mathcal{U}} \sum_{i=1}^n w_i B_F(\theta_i : \theta(u)) &= \sum_{i=1}^n w_i (F(\theta_i) - F(\theta(u)) - \langle \theta_i - \theta(u), \nabla F(\theta(u)) \rangle), \\ &\equiv -F(\theta(u)) - \langle \bar{\theta} - \theta(u), \nabla F(\theta(u)) \rangle, \\ &\equiv F(\bar{\theta}) - F(\theta(u)) - \langle \bar{\theta} - \theta(u), \nabla F(\theta(u)) \rangle \\ &= B_F(\bar{\theta} : \theta(u)). \end{aligned}$$



"What is... an information projection?" Notices of the AMS 65.3 (2018): 321-324.

Bregman divergences and gauge freedom

Convex functions remain convex by scaling, adding affine term and reparameterization by affine transformations:
Underlying geometry are dually flat spaces (M, g, ∇, ∇^*) .

$$\bar{F}(\theta) = \lambda F(A\theta + b) + \langle c, \theta \rangle + d \quad \Rightarrow \quad \eta = \nabla \bar{F}(\theta) = \lambda A^\top \nabla F(A\theta + b) + c.$$

$A \in GL(d, \mathbb{R})$, vectors $b, c \in \mathbb{R}^d$ and scalars $d \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}$

$$\nabla \bar{G}(\eta) = A^{-1} \nabla G \left(\frac{1}{\lambda} A^{-\top} (\eta - c) \right) - b \quad \Rightarrow \quad \bar{G}(\eta) = \langle \eta, \nabla \bar{G}(\eta) \rangle - F(\nabla \bar{G}(\eta))$$

$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = \frac{1}{\lambda} B_{\bar{F}}(\bar{\theta}_1 : \bar{\theta}_2) \quad \text{with} \quad \bar{\theta} = A^{-1}(\theta - b)$$

$$D_{\nabla, \nabla^*}(p_1 : p_2) = B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = \frac{1}{\lambda} B_{\bar{F}}(\bar{\theta}_1 : \bar{\theta}_2)$$

Affine Legendre
Invariance
+

Divergence unit

2301.10980

Hessian (Riemannian) geometry from Bregman generators

Metric tensor in primal coordinates:

$$g_{ij}(\theta) = \nabla^2 F(\theta)$$

Dual metric tensor in dual coordinates:

$$g^{ij}(\eta) = g^{*ij}(\eta) = \nabla^2 F^*(\eta)$$

Crouzeix's identity: $\nabla^2 F(\theta) \nabla^2 F^*(\eta) = I$

A Bregman generator thus define a Riemannian geodesic length distance

Reparameterization of metric tensors $I_\theta(\theta) \xrightarrow{\eta=\eta(\theta)} I_\eta(\eta) = \left[\frac{\partial \theta_i}{\partial \eta_j} \right]^\top \times I_\theta(\theta(\eta)) \times \left[\frac{\partial \theta_i}{\partial \eta_j} \right]$

Separable Bregman divergences (product of 1D EFs...)

... **always** yield **Euclidean geometry** (in non-Cartesian coords)

$$\delta_{\Phi}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}') = \Phi(\mathbf{x}) - \Phi(\mathbf{x}') - (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}')^{\top} \nabla \Phi(\mathbf{x}')$$

$$\Phi(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{j=1}^K \phi(x_j) \text{ with } \phi : \mathcal{J} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

$$\delta_{\Phi}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}') = \sum_{j=1}^K \delta_{\phi}(x_j, x'_j)$$

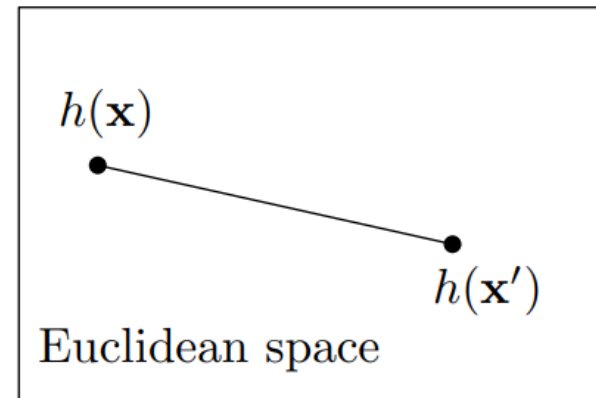
Geodesic distance (Rao distance): $d_{\phi}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}')^2 = \sum_{j=1}^K (h(x_j) - h(x'_j))^2$

where $h(x) = \int \sqrt{\phi''(x)}$ $g_{i,j}(\mathbf{x}) = \phi''(x_i)\delta_{i,j}$ Diagonal matrix

geodesics $\gamma_i(t) = h^{-1}\left((1-t)h(x_i) + th(x'_i)\right)$

$$I_{\theta}(\theta) \xrightarrow{\eta=\eta(\theta)} I_{\eta}(\eta) = \left[\frac{\partial \theta_i}{\partial \eta_j} \right]^{\top} \times I_{\theta}(\theta(\eta)) \times \left[\frac{\partial \theta_i}{\partial \eta_j} \right]$$

Jacobian matrix $y=h(x)$



Squaring Hessian matrices yield Euclidean geometry

Crouzeix identity: $\nabla_{\eta}^2 F^*(\eta)^\top \nabla^2 F(\theta(\eta)) = I_{m,m}$

Squared any Hessian matrix to get **another SPD matrix** representing a metric:

$$G_{\text{sqr}}(\eta) = \nabla_{\eta}^2 F^*(\eta)^\top (\nabla^2 F(\theta(\eta)))^2 \nabla_{\eta}^2 F^*(\eta) = I_{m,m}.$$

Geodesic distance is the **Euclidean distance on the dual parameters**:

$$\rho_{g_{\text{sqr}}}(P_1, P_2) = \|\eta_1 - \eta_2\|_2 = \|\nabla F(\theta_1) - \nabla F(\theta_2)\|_2$$
$$\eta_i = \nabla F(\theta(P_i))$$

Instead of Cholesky decomp of SPD, we can take symmetric square root:

It is SPD matrix and square it. Mahalanobis is thus Euclidean geometry 2511.21173

Six short stories

- Bregman divergences for cumulant & partition functions yield reverse KLD and extended reverse KLD divergences
- Log ratio exponential family are 1D exponential family (e-geodesic of geometric mixtures). Application: Chernoff information
- Bregman generators can be chosen modulo affine terms: Characterize MC error of KLD estimation exactly using sigma points
- Curved Bregman centroids are projections of Bregman centroids (symmetrized BDs)
- Bregman divergences and gauge freedom
- Hessian geometry from Bregman generators and Euclidean geometry

Implementing information geometry

Stochastic Bregman generator / Random information geometry
Numerical information geometry / Neural information geometry

Stochastic/random information geometry

- In many cases, dual structures of information geometry are not available in closed-forms or comp. tractable (polynomial EF, continuous mixture family). **With high probability**, we can sample the generator integrals and get proper Bregman generators

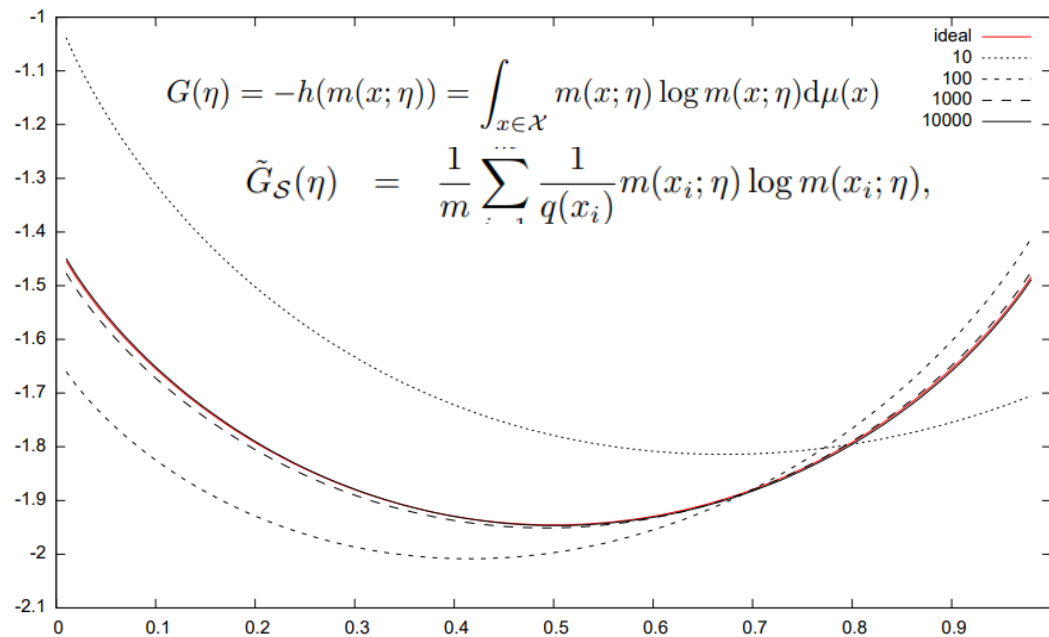
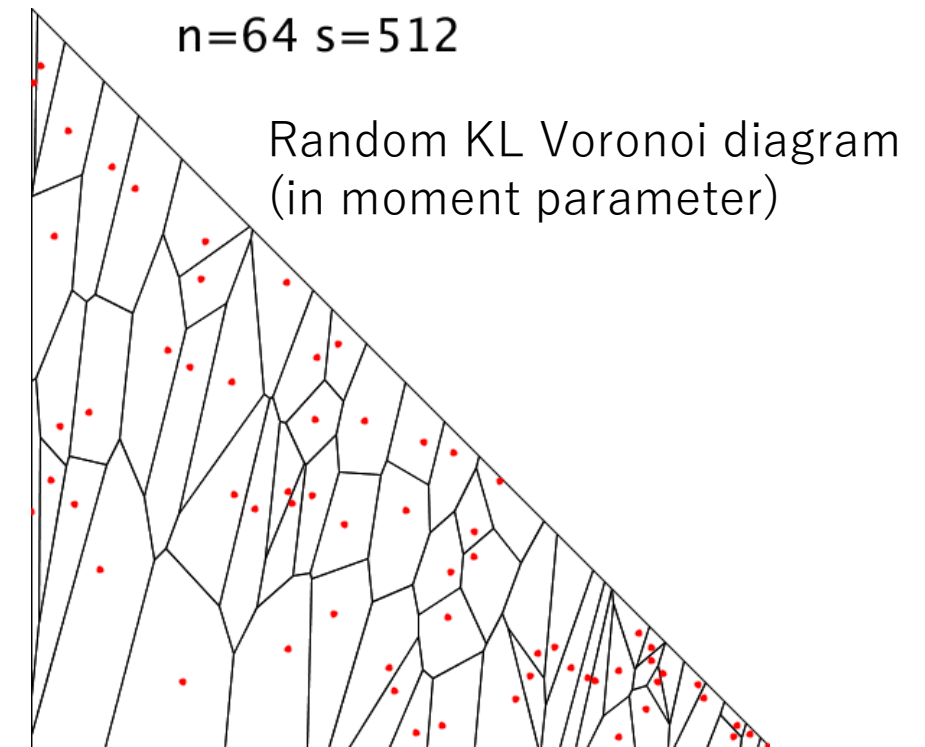


Figure 2: A series $G_S(\eta)$ of Bregman Monte Carlo Mixture Family generators (for $m = |\mathcal{S}| \in \{10, 100, 1000, 10000\}$) approximating the untractable ideal negentropy generator $G(\eta) = -h(m(x; \eta))$ (red) of a mixture family with prescribed Gaussian distributions $m(x; \eta) = (1 - \eta)p(x; 0, 3) + \eta p(x; 2, 1)$ for the proposal distribution $q(x) = m(x; \frac{1}{2})$.

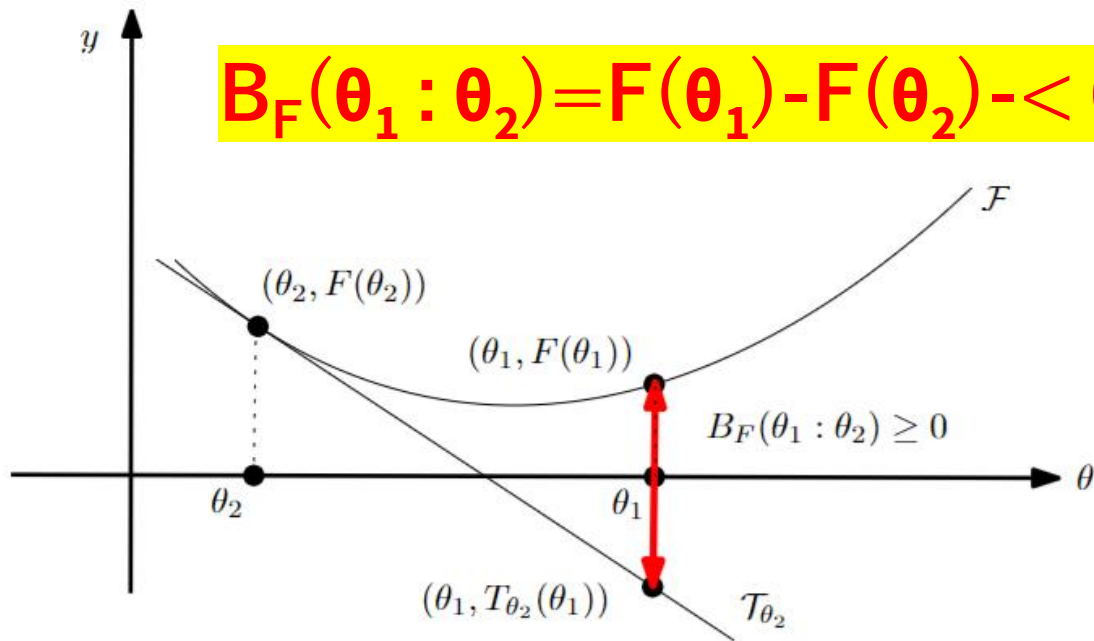


Dual Bregman/Fenchel-Young divergences

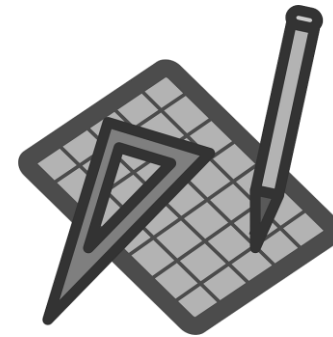
- Let $F: \Theta \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a strictly convex and smooth real-valued function on a Hilbert space $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$

Bregman divergence $B_F: \Theta \times \text{Int}(\Theta) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = F(\theta_1) - F(\theta_2) - \langle \theta_1 - \theta_2, \nabla F(\theta_2) \rangle$$



Popular in geometry, information theory, signal/sound processing!



$$B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) = Y_{F, F^*}(\theta_1 : \eta_2) = Y_{F^*, F}(\eta_2, \theta_1) = B_{F^*}(\eta_2 : \eta_1)$$

Reconstructing statistical divergences from Bregman divergences with integral generators

$$F(\theta) = F_{\mathcal{E}}(p_{\theta}) = \log \left(\int \exp(\theta^{\top} t(x)) d\mu(x) \right)$$

$$F_{\mathcal{M}}(m_{\theta}) = -h(m_{\theta}) = \int m_{\theta}(x) \log m_{\theta}(x) d\mu(x)$$

Statistical models with dual e/m flatness

- **Exponential families:** $\mathcal{E}_{t,\mu} := \{p(x; \theta) \propto \exp(\langle t(x), \theta \rangle)\}_{\theta},$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{KL}(p(x; \theta_1) : p(x; \theta_2)) &= B_F(\theta_2 : \theta_1), & F(\theta) &:= \log \left(\int_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \exp(\langle t(x), \theta \rangle) d\mu(x) \right) \\ &= B_{F^*}(\eta_1 : \eta_2), & \eta &= E_{p(x; \theta)}[t(x)] \\ & & \text{FIM} \quad g_{ij}(\theta) &= \partial_i \partial_j F(\theta) \\ & & & g = \text{Var}[t(X)] \end{aligned}$$

- **Mixture families:** $\mathcal{M} := \left\{ m(x; \eta) = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i p_i(x) + (1 - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i) p_0(x) : \eta_i > 0, \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \eta_i < 1 \right\}$

$$\text{KL}(m(x; \eta) : m(x; \eta')) = B_G(\eta : \eta') \quad G(\eta) = -h(m(x; \eta)) = \int_{x \in \mathcal{X}} m(x; \eta) \log m(x; \eta) d\mu(x)$$

$$\text{FIM} \quad g_{ij}(\eta) = -\partial_i \partial_j h(\eta)$$

Remarks:

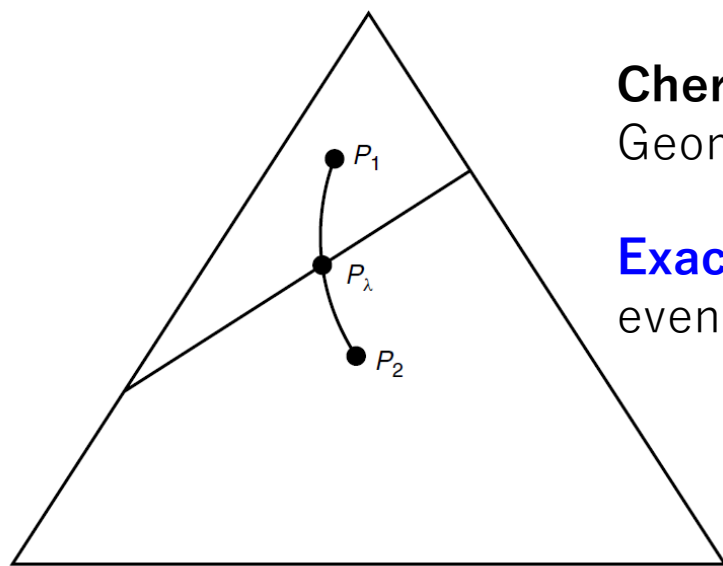
- EFs and MFs are *not flat* with respect to the Levi-Civita g-connection
- Many statistical models are not e/m flat: Ex. Cauchy family

Chernoff information (Bayesian hypothesis testing)

$$C(P_1, P_2) \triangleq - \min_{0 \leq \lambda \leq 1} \log \left(\sum_x P_1^\lambda(x) P_2^{1-\lambda}(x) \right)$$

$$= D(P_{\lambda^*} || P_1) = D(P_{\lambda^*} || P_2)$$

$$C(P, Q) = - \log \min_{\alpha \in (0,1)} \int p^\alpha(x) q^{1-\alpha}(x) d\nu(x).$$



$$P_\lambda = \frac{P_1^\lambda(x) P_2^{1-\lambda}(x)}{\sum_{a \in \mathcal{X}} P_1^\lambda(a) P_2^{1-\lambda}(a)}$$

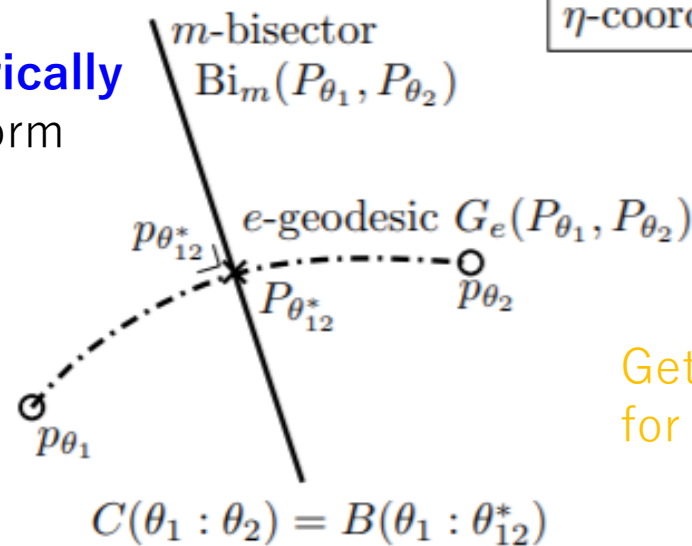
Chernoff distribution =
Geometric mixture for optimal exponent

Exactly characterized geometrically
even if not available in closed form



$$P^* = P_{\theta_{12}^*} = G_e(P_1, P_2) \cap \text{Bi}_m(P_1, P_2)$$

η -coordinate system



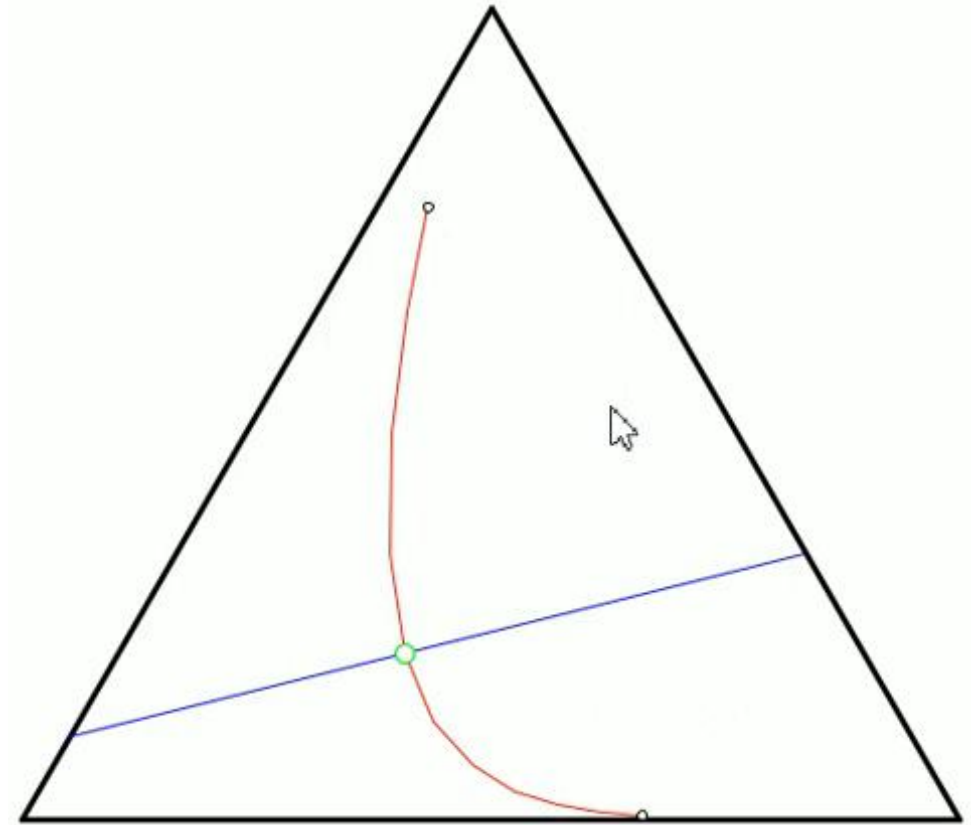
Get large formula
for 1D Gaussians!!!

Categorical/Shannon manifold

Exponential family manifold

In pure geometric term, **Chernoff point**
intersection of primal geodesic with dual bisector

Unique intersection point of
the exponential geodesic
with
the dual mixture bisector



(Here 2D probability simplex of the family of categorical distributions with 3 choices)

Hilbertian metrization of Bregman divergences: Curved Bregman divergences

Bregman divergence for a smooth strictly convex function F

$$B_F = B_F(\theta : \theta') := F(\theta) - F(\theta') - \langle \theta - \theta', \nabla F(\theta') \rangle:$$

Jeffreys symmetrization does not yield square root metrization $\sqrt{S_F}$

$$\begin{aligned} S_F(\theta_1, \theta_2) &:= B_F(\theta_1 : \theta_2) + B_F(\theta_2 : \theta_1) \\ &= \langle \theta_2 - \theta_1, \nabla F(\theta_2) - \nabla F(\theta_1) \rangle \end{aligned}$$

Hilbertian metrization

$$S_F^{(\alpha, \beta)}(\theta_1, \theta_2) = \|\Phi_{\alpha, \beta}(\theta_1) - \Phi_{\alpha, \beta}(\theta_2)\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} S_F^{(\alpha, \beta)}(\theta_1, \theta_2) &= \langle \theta_2 - \theta_1, \nabla F(\theta_2) - \nabla F(\theta_1) \rangle \\ &\quad + \frac{\alpha}{2} \langle \theta_2 - \theta_1, \theta_2 - \theta_1 \rangle + \frac{\beta}{2} \langle \nabla F(\theta_2) - \nabla F(\theta_1), \nabla F(\theta_2) - \nabla F(\theta_1) \rangle, \end{aligned}$$

$$\Phi_{\alpha, \beta}(\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{\alpha}\theta + \frac{1}{\sqrt{\alpha}}\nabla F(\theta) \\ \sqrt{\frac{\alpha\beta-1}{\alpha}}\nabla F(\theta) \end{bmatrix}$$

Hilbertian metrization is a **curved Bregman divergence**

$$\begin{aligned} S_F^{(\alpha, \beta)}(\theta_1, \theta_2) &= \|\Phi_{\alpha, \beta}(\theta_1) - \Phi_{\alpha, \beta}(\theta_2)\|_2^2 \\ &= B_{\hat{F}}(\xi(\theta_1) : \xi(\theta_2)), \quad \xi(\theta) = (\theta, \nabla F(\theta)) \end{aligned}$$

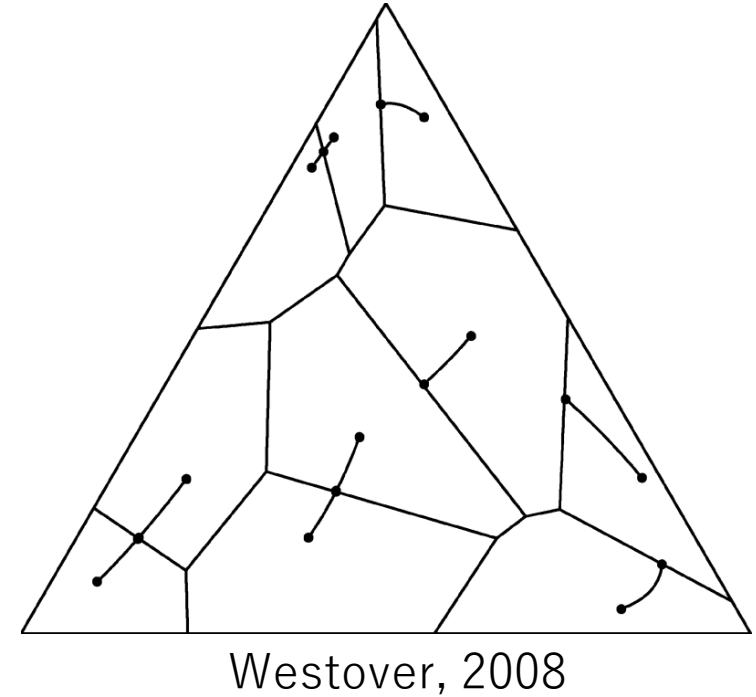
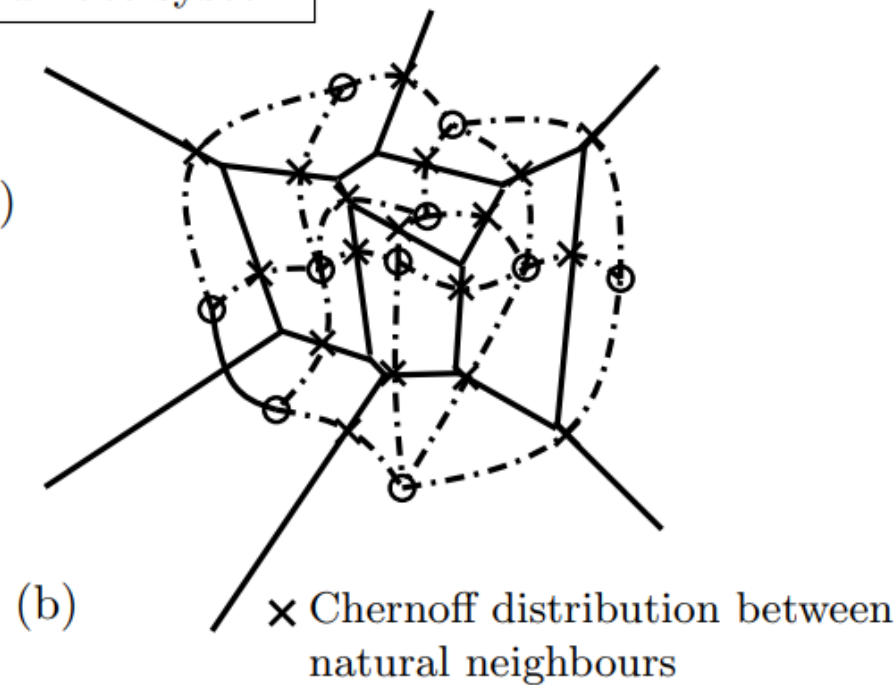
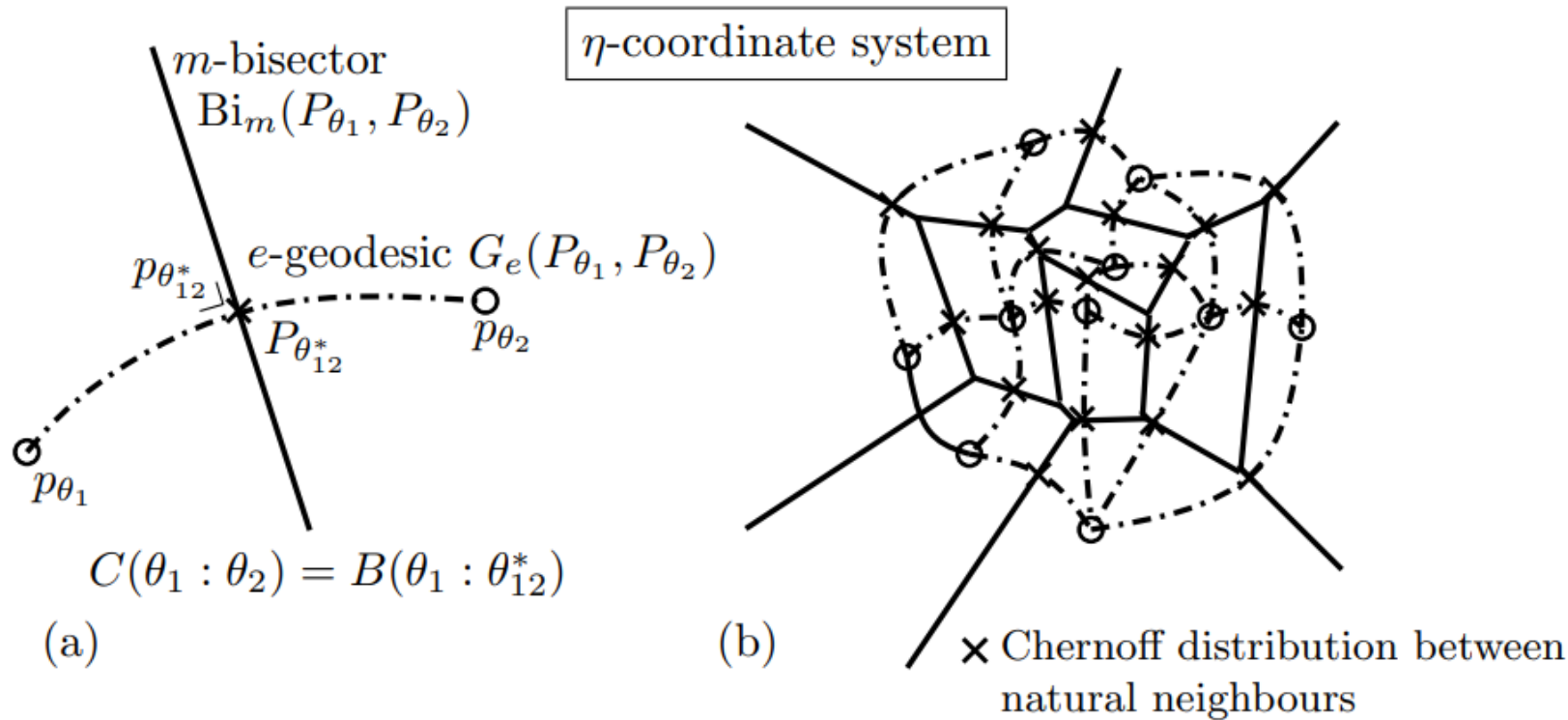
$$\hat{F}_{\alpha, \beta}(\xi_1, \xi_2) = F(\xi_1) + \frac{\alpha}{2} \langle \xi_1, \xi_1 \rangle + F^*(\xi_2) + \frac{\beta}{2} \langle \xi_2, \xi_2 \rangle$$

arXiv:2504.05654

Chernoff information of multiple distributions

Defined as the **minimum of pairwise Chernoff information**

Computed by inspecting **natural neighbors** in **Voronoi diagrams**



Bregman Voronoi diagrams